

New BEGININGS





**REVERED PROFESSOR
DR. VISHWANATH D. KARAD**
FOUNDER - PRESIDENT, MIT-WPU



SHRI RAHUL V. KARAD
EXECUTIVE PRESIDENT, MIT-WPU

FOUNDER'S MESSAGE

Social equality is a fundamental pillar of a just and fair society. It ensures that every individual has the same opportunities and rights regardless of their social status, gender, ethnicity, or religion. The belief that social equality is not only a moral responsibility but also a necessary condition for a thriving community is etched in the hearts of everyone at MIT-WPU.

We strive to create an inclusive environment where everyone feels valued and respected. It gives me immense happiness to say that the students of MIT-WPU, have acted as the true ambassadors of the institution by making the campus a place where diversity is celebrated, and differences are embraced. The encouragement to open dialogue and constructive engagement for a better understanding and empathy has been one of the hallmarks of our students, faculty, and staff.

However, we recognize that there is still much work to be done to achieve true social equality. We must continue to challenge discrimination and inequality in all forms and advocate for policies and practices that promote fairness and justice for all.

Let us work together to build a society that is truly equitable and just, where every individual has the opportunity to fulfill their potential and contribute to the greater good. At MIT-WPU, we remain committed to advancing social equality and promoting a culture of inclusion and diversity.

FROM THE EXECUTIVE PRESIDENT'S DESK

Dear Members of the MIT-WPU Family,

As we embark on this new journey together, I am filled with hope and anticipation for the possibilities that lie ahead. The theme of "New Beginnings" resonates deeply within our community, symbolising not only the start of a new academic year but also the opportunity for personal growth, innovation, and positive change.

At MIT World Peace University, we are committed to nurturing not only academic excellence but also compassion, empathy, and understanding. It is through dialogue and cooperation that we can build bridges across cultures and borders, working towards a world where peace and harmony prevail.

As we walk on this journey together, let us remember that each of us has the power to make a difference, both in our community and in the world at large. Let us strive for excellence, guided by the values of integrity, respect, and empathy.

Together, let us create a future where harmony and world peace are not just ideals, but a reality that we actively work towards each day.

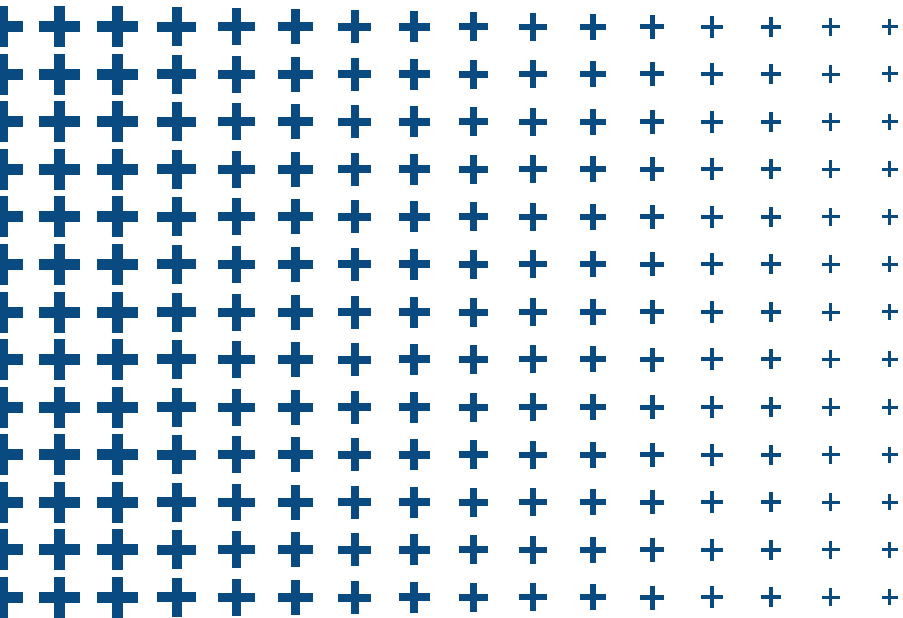
Rahul V. Karad
Executive President, MIT-WPU

DID YOU KNOW?

World Peace Centre (Alandi) MAEER'S MIT, Pune India instituted the **"Philosopher Saint Shree Dnyaneswara World Peace Prize"** in the year 2006 on the lines of the **Nobel Peace Prize** for the promotion of **"Culture of Peace"** in the world. This World Peace Prize is unique and perhaps the first of its kind in the country.

The first **World Peace Prize** for 2005 was awarded to **Her Holiness Mata Amritanandamayi Devi**, the renowned spiritual leader with millions of followers across the world, beyond any cast, creed, religion and boundaries of nations and who is more fondly known as **'Amma - The Mother'**

The second **World Peace Prize** in the name of Philosopher Saint Dnyaneshwar for 2006 was awarded to **Sri Sri Ravi Shankarji**, the world's famous spiritual leader and the promoter of the unique **'Art of Living'** concept to promote World Peace.



HAPPENINGS

STUDENTS LEAD ROAD SAFETY AWARENESS INITIATIVE



Students from the Operations and Supply Chain Forum at the Ramcharan School of Leadership and School of Business demonstrated their commitment to social responsibility by participating in a Road Safety awareness drive. This initiative was led by the Forum's President, **Mr. Alfaz Mutawalli**, and received substantial support from **Mr. Rama Shankar Pandey**, the CEO of Tata Green Batteries, representing the Tata Group of Industries.



TREK TO RAIRESHWAR FORT

The School of Education at MIT-WPU, in collaboration with Nisargavedh, recently organised a trek to Rareshwar Fort, enriching faculty and students with a blend of physical activity and historical exploration. This site, famous for its ancient temple where Chhatrapati Shivaji Maharaj vowed for Hindavi Swarajya, offered breathtaking views at Necklace Point, Suspension Bridge, and more, along with the unique geological feature of seven soil colours. This trek emphasised the school's dedication to promoting well-being through engaging educational experiences.

EXPLORING LEADERSHIP FRONTIERS

A session focusing on various aspects of leadership, including Leadership in Crisis, Heroic Leadership, and Distributed Leadership, was expertly coordinated. The event featured insights from **Prof. Robert McMurray**, Professor of Organisational Studies and Associate Dean at **The University of Sheffield**, along with **Ms. Shirley Wang**, International Relations Manager at the **University of Sheffield, UK**. This event underscored the importance of leadership skills in today's dynamic environment.



ECO-FRIENDLY DIWALI CELEBRATION



FOSTERING INNOVATION



The community is thrilled to announce the launch of an innovative Co-Creation activity, a testament to the collaborative genius of **Dr. Joske Bunders**, **Shri. Rahul Vishwanath Karad**, and **Dr. Emmy de Wit**. This initiative, developed in cooperation with professors and students from MIT-World Peace University, is designed to revolutionise the way we approach research. The course emphasises that research is not only achievable and pertinent but also enjoyable. It focuses on collective problem-solving and equips participants with the necessary tools and methods for effective collaboration. Participants will engage with peers in a journey of discovery, learning to foster an open, creative mindset that is beneficial not only for research endeavours but also in broader work, societal, and personal contexts. This initiative represents a significant step forward in promoting innovative thinking and collaborative solutions within our community.

VISIT OF US TEAM MEDLINE INDUSTRIES, ONE OF THE TOP COMPANIES IN HEALTH CARE SECTOR TO MIT WPU CAMPUS



In another noteworthy event, the MIT-WPU campus was graced with a visit from the US Team of Medline Industries, one of the top companies in the healthcare sector. These events reflect the ongoing commitment to excellence and the fostering of global connections.

Students from the School of Education embraced sustainability this Diwali by crafting eco-friendly lanterns. This initiative highlighted the importance of celebrating festivals responsibly, aligning tradition with environmental consciousness.

WORKSHOP ON CRAFTING TRADITIONAL LEARNING RESOURCES



The School of Education recently conducted a workshop on "**Creating Traditional Learning Resources**," led by **Assistant Professor Jyoti Tekale**. Emphasising the continued importance of traditional educational tools, the workshop enabled students to create a variety of 2D and 3D learning materials for all school subjects, including innovative 2D folders, folding files, and magic files. This session provided practical skills in making and presenting diverse learning resources, catering to different learner needs and highlighting the integral role of traditional resources in enriching the educational experience.



BIOENGINEERING STUDENTS GAIN INSIGHTS AT MALA'S AND PURE GOLD FACTORIES

SY B.Tech Bioengineering Students Explore Food Processing at Panchgani Industries On February 16th, the SY B.Tech Bioengineering class from Dr. Vishwanath Karad MIT World Peace University embarked on an industrial visit to Panchgani. Led by **Professor Sagar Kanekar** and laboratory assistants, the students gained valuable insights into food bioprocessing firsthand at Mala's Restaurant and Food Factory and Pure Gold Cheese Factory.

At Mala's, students witnessed the transformation of green apples into syrup, observing the application of enzymes like pectin in thickening and stabilisation. While automation played a significant role, human intervention remained crucial for quality control.

Pure Gold Cheese Factory offered a glimpse into cheese, jam, and chocolate production. Despite technical limitations affecting live observation, detailed explanations and tastings illuminated the differences between raw and processed cheese, the intricacies of chocolate processing, and the use of preservatives and stabilisers in jams.

This visit proved invaluable, deepening the students' understanding of bioprocess engineering principles within the food industry. They observed the importance of enzyme utilisation, automation integration, and human oversight in quality control. They gained insights into fermentation, microbial cultures, and the impact of raw materials and processing on product characteristics.

The entire class expresses gratitude to **Programme Director Dr. Dinesh Bhutada** for facilitating this enriching experience.

EXPLORING NATURE'S MARVELS

Students from the **Department of Environmental Studies** embarked on an insightful two-day field visit to Bhigwan Lake, Solapur, and Rehkuri Blackbuck Sanctuary, Ahmednagar, on the 1st and 2nd of February, respectively. This educational journey aimed to deepen their understanding of wetlands and sanctuaries, focusing on their significance, management practices, and the intricate balance between biodiversity and local communities. The visit kicked off with an evening birding session at Bhigwan Lake, where students observed a diverse array of birdlife and engaged in discussions about the critical role of wetlands. Highlights included sightings of a camouflaged Rock Bush Quail, a predatory Indian Chameleon, a resting Jungle Cat, and a nesting Indian Nightjar. The following day at Rehekuri Blackbuck Sanctuary, students delved into the unique biodiversity of grasslands and the impact of human activities on these ecosystems. Through these experiences, they gained valuable insights into the interconnectedness of economic practices, local participation, and the preservation of sensitive habitats. This excursion not only enriched their academic knowledge but also fostered a deeper appreciation for the natural world.



IGNITING INNOVATION

The Department of Mechanical Engineering has started **Indian Institute of Welding Student Associate Activities 2024-25** at our campus under the Advanced Welding and Simulator Lab. Central Workshop, DoME, MITWPU.



EMPOWERING COMMUNITIES

Over the past five months, **Sibani Singh** under the **JSW Foundation** Fellowship has been deeply engaged in community development, rural development, water management, and strengthening community ties. This dedicated practitioner has led impactful projects aimed at fostering positive changes in underprivileged areas. By engaging local communities in participatory decision-making, conducting needs assessments, and facilitating meetings, they have spearheaded initiatives to improve educational access, waste management, and overall well-being.

In rural development, efforts have focused on empowering marginalised populations through income-generating activities, agricultural training, and micro-enterprise promotion, aiming for economic and social sustainability. Water management initiatives led by the fellow have addressed water scarcity and sanitation, installing water harvesting systems and promoting sustainable water use to improve access to clean water and support local agriculture.

Community strengthening has been a key focus, aiming to build capacity, enhance leadership skills, and foster social cohesion through the establishment of community-based organisations and training sessions. These experiences highlight the transformative power of community-led development, showcasing how collaborative efforts can create resilient and self-reliant communities, inspiring a continued commitment to community betterment.



THE NEW CHAPTER OF KNOWLEDGE AT KRC 2024

The **Knowledge Resource Centre (KRC)** is all set for a fresh start in 2024, having undergone renovations to better serve the needs of students, faculty, and research scholars. The newly refurbished "**Agasthya**" building is now exclusively **dedicated to the university library**, offering cutting-edge services and facilities. With reading collections spread across multiple floors, including designated reading halls **accommodating up to 1200 students**, the KRC provides ample space for study and research. Additional amenities such as separate discussion rooms, a digital library, and robust security measures ensure a seamless and secure experience for all users. The KRC team, along with visionary top management, remains committed to realising the university's vision and mission, inviting everyone to make the most of this enhanced facility.



MARKETING INNOVATION AT MITWPU'S INTER-COLLEGIATE COMPETITION

AdArena, organised by **UTKARSH**, the business club at SOEC, MIT-WPU, on February 10th, 2024, was a vibrant inter-collegiate marketing competition held at MIT-WPU. The event drew over 25 participants from various Pune colleges, challenging them to pitch innovative products or services. A panel comprising industry experts **Mr. Bharat Oswal**, **Mr. Sreekanth Naidu**, and faculty **Dr. Shubhangi Gaikwad** judged the entries on creativity, presentation, and confidence, eventually selecting three winners. Esteemed guests **Prof. Ashish Kathale** and **Prof. Dr. Anjali Sane** highlighted the event's significance in promoting business acumen and innovation among students. AdArena exemplified Utkarsh Club's commitment to nurturing future business leaders and entrepreneurs.



IN THE SPOTLIGHT

BHARTIYA CHHATRA SANSAD (BCS)

Bhartiya Chhatra Sansad has created a youth movement by connecting thousands of youth across the nation with hope and assurance. Politically and socially active **students from 450 universities** from all states of India go through a rigorous selection process adopted by their colleges independently and **10000 - 12000** of them finally get an opportunity to participate in the **flagship annual conclave of BCS**. These young leaders are engaged in absorbing academic sessions to discuss and deliberate on a wide range of significant issues. A number of political leaders, thought leaders, intellectual giants, industrial leaders and youth icons of national and international eminence, from all walks of life and spectrum of ideologies provide them with the context, analysis, courage, insight and perspective so that they can dream bigger, see clearer and speak louder.



ACHIEVEMENTS

"EDUDRONE TEACHER'S GOT TALENT" AWARD 2023

In a remarkable achievement, **Chandrani**, a student at the School of Education, clinched the **top prize in the 2023 "Edudrone Teacher's Got Talent"** award. Chandrani's innovative art integration presentation, designed to aid preparation for the National Education Policy (NEP), captivated the judges and secured her the first-place position.

This outstanding accomplishment underscores Chandrani's creativity, talent, and dedication to pioneering teaching methods. The School of Education takes immense pride in her stellar achievement and celebrates her well-deserved success in this prestigious competition.



SHOWCASING EXCELLENCE IN DEBATE ON SELF-RELIANCE

The School of Education at MIT-WPU proudly announces that first-year B.Ed. students, **Madhavi Bhoite and Sakshi Khande** secured a Consolation Prize in a State-level Inter-Collegiate Debate Competition at Manikchand Pahade Law College, Sambhaji Nagar. Guided by **Dr. Vandana Kenjale** and **Assistant Professor Priya Kale**, they impressively presented their thoughts on **"Atmanirbhar Bharat versus the colonial mindset of India,"** demonstrating their insightful understanding and advocacy for India's self-reliance. This achievement underscores the school's dedication to fostering critical thinking and eloquence among its students.



RECOGNITION FOR EXCELLENCE IN LESSON CONDUCTION

The School of Education at MIT-WPU is proud to announce that **Gayatri Charantimath**, a second-year B.Ed. student has been awarded a Consolation Prize in the **"Best Lesson Conduction"** category at an Intercollegiate Competition held at Pratibha College of Education, Chinchwad. Under the guidance of **Dr. Vandana Kenjale** and **Assistant Professor Priya Kale**, Gayatri's achievement exemplifies our commitment to fostering educational excellence and innovation. This accolade not only highlights her pedagogical skills but also represents the quality of mentorship provided by our faculty.



MIT-WPU EMBARKS ON DIGITAL TRANSFORMATION JOURNEY WITH NEW ERP SYSTEM

MIT-WPU is thrilled to announce the launch of a **new ERP implementation project - "WPU Rainbow"** on February 14th, 2024. Partnering with renowned PwC, we're adopting their **"Integrated Education Management System (IEMS)"** to streamline key processes across various departments.

Phase 1: This initial phase integrates essential modules like Academics, LMS, Procurement, Finance, and Examinations. Additionally, it will be linked with **"No Paper Forms"** for admissions and **"CodeTantra"** for exams, enhancing efficiency.

Mobile Convenience: Both students and staff will benefit from dedicated mobile apps, providing easy access to critical information on the go.

Future Phases: Further integration with HROne, Koha (Library), Superset (placements), and advanced exam features are planned for later stages.

Benefits: This project aligns with our digital transformation strategy, aiming to:

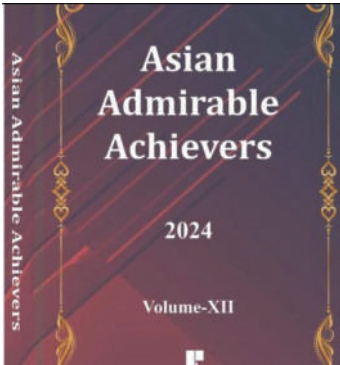
- + Streamline processes for increased efficiency and productivity.
- + Embrace agility to adapt to evolving market demands.
- + Enhance sustainability through paperless initiatives.
- + Boost talent retention with improved workflows and employee experience.

Timeline: Expect completion within 6 months, with most schools and departments involved directly or indirectly.



MIT-WPU EMBARKS ON DIGITAL TRANSFORMATION JOURNEY WITH NEW ERP SYSTEM

Reguerdon Inc., a highly reputed publishing house known for its biographical books, has recently honoured Ms. Shobana Anand, Assistant Director of CIAP - Division 3 & 4, by nominating her for inclusion in the XIth edition of Asian Admirable Achievers. This prestigious nomination by the editorial selection board highlights her significant contributions and achievements.

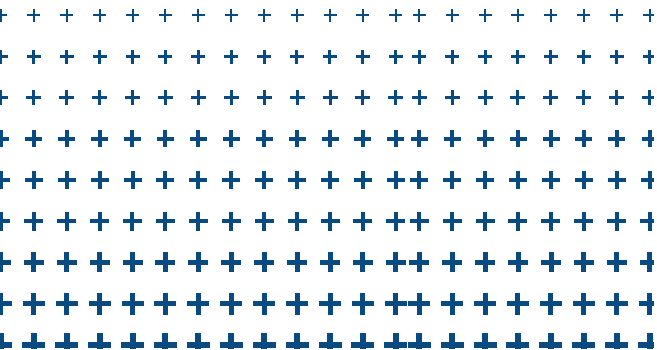


Website:
www.asianadmirableachievers.in, www.rifacimento.in

This is to certify that Mrs. Shobana Anand has been honoured with the inclusion of her/his biographical profile with photograph in XIth edition of the Asian Admirable Achievers.



Ravi Bhushan
Compiling Editor.



SCHOLARLY SUCCESS

Dr. Rahul Vishwanath Dandage an Associate Professor at the Department of Business, has reached a significant milestone on his research paper, **garnering 100 citations** on Google Scholar and surpassing 50 citations on the **Scopus Author profile**.

This marks a commendable accomplishment in the realm of scholarly research.

Scopus

52 documents have cited:

Analysis of interactions among barriers in project risk management
Dandage R.V., Mantha S.S., Rane S.B., Bhoola V.
(2018) Journal of Industrial Engineering International, 14 (1) , pp. 153-169.



Dr. Rahul Vishwanath Dandage
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Verified email at mitwpu.edu.in
Project risk management International projects SCM & BPR Industrial engineering and ...
Operations Management

TITLE	CITED BY	YEAR
Analysis of interactions among barriers in project risk management RV Dandage, SS Mantha, SB Rane, V Bhoola Journal of Industrial Engineering International 14, 153-169	100	2018

COLLABORATIONS FOR ENVIRONMENTAL SUSTAINABILITY

Dr. Prasad Kulkarni, the Programme Director at the Department of Environmental Studies, was a distinguished speaker at the Water Security & Conservation event on February 10th in Goa. He shared the stage with notable figures such as Mr. Ajith Radhakrishnan from the World Bank, Ms. Rupa Dawane of the JSW Foundation, Mr. Surojit Bose from Hindustan Coca-Cola Beverages, and Ms. Aditi Haksar from the Confederation Indian Industry. Beyond delivering his talk, Dr. Kulkarni engaged with various professionals, including a meeting with Mr. Akash Counto, Director of the Alcon Group, to discuss a potential research collaboration. This engagement highlighted the conference's role in bridging academic and industry efforts towards environmental sustainability.

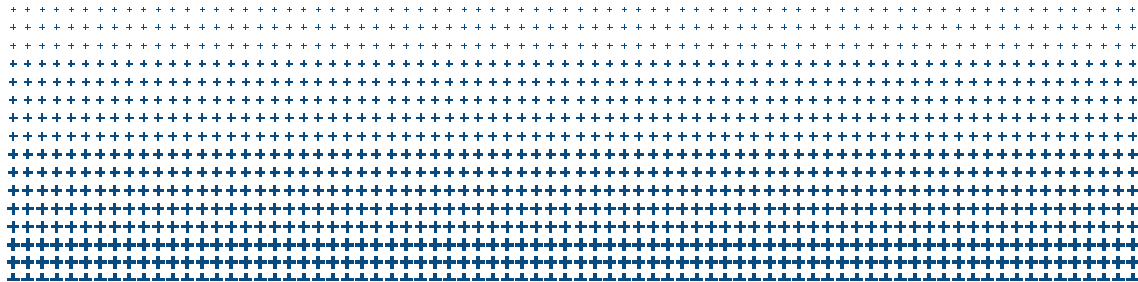


INTERNATIONAL CONFERENCE ON DIGITAL DESIGNS

The MIT-WPU Pune and the Peace Research Institute Oslo co-hosted the International Conference on "Digital Designs" on February 9th and 10th, 2024. This conference gathered experts and enthusiasts to explore the intersections of digital technology, society, and peace. Notable discussions covered artificial intelligence, digital governance, and cybersecurity, emphasising the need for ethical digital advancements. The event concluded with a call to responsibly use digital technologies for societal betterment, marked by the symbolic Universal Anthem "Pasaydan."

PATHWAY FORWARD FOR CHARTERED ACCOUNTANT STUDENTS

The School of Economics and Commerce, in collaboration with the **Institute of Chartered Accountants of India (ICAI)**, held an interactive meeting to explore pathways for Chartered Accountant students. This meeting, part of a new memorandum of understanding between the two institutions, focused on organising seminars, workshops, and career counseling sessions. Esteemed guests including **CA Arpit Kabra** and **CA Sourabh Ajmera** attended the session, which also laid the groundwork for a joint conference on Sustainability scheduled in March 2023. The event, symbolising a bridge between academic knowledge and professional practice, promises to enhance the educational journey of Chartered Accountant students.



Painting with WORDS



Start the art and follow your heart,
Hold my hand and make it grand.
Really, it's just there!
let's begin from here.
Hurdle in 2023 was just a lil guest,
Heading ahead is a matter of quest.
The hard work does not lie,
All the sorrows will surely die.
2024 will bring you light again,
The future will shine bright again.
Forget if it was a hit or a flop,
Destiny will surely take a hop.
Resurgence is a good choice,
let the success make a noise.
Have courage to discover
new pathway,
Believe the almighty and begin to pray.
Troughs and crests surely he will bring,
You just deep breath an
aroma of spring.
Dear,
Keep walking a step or a few,
The good idea is to start a fresh new!



A FRESH NEW 2024

by Asst. Prof. Prachee Somvanshi
School of Education

A silhouette of a person standing on a cliff with arms raised in a 'V' shape, next to large, bold numbers '2024'. The background is a warm sunset or sunrise over a city skyline.

2024



Your Living



The heartbeat of MIT-WPU

Dearest MIT-WPU,

As we step into another vibrant year at MIT World Peace University, I am filled with a profound sense of gratitude and anticipation.

Looking back, we've journeyed through challenges and triumphs, each step cast us into a more resilient and united family. As we embrace this new chapter, I wish to extend my heartfelt wishes to every student, faculty member, and staff at MIT-WPU. Your dedication, creativity, and passion are the bedrock of our institution's success and the driving force behind our mission to make a positive impact on the world.

This year promises to be a canvas of opportunities. As we continue to innovate in education, research, and community engagement, let us also cherish and nurture the values of peace, harmony, and sustainability that stand at the core of MIT-WPU. Together, we will explore new horizons, create meaningful change, and empower each other to reach new heights.

To our newcomers, welcome to the MIT-WPU family! You are taking off on an exciting journey that will shape your future and enrich your life in unimaginable ways. And to our returning students and colleagues, your continued commitment and enthusiasm inspire us all.

Let "New Beginnings" be a silver lining and a testament to our collective aspiration for a brighter, more inclusive future. Here's to a year of growth, discovery, and success.

Warmest regards and best wishes for an incredible 2024.

*Yours truly,
Pulse.*

Narrated by: Nameera Uzair

Editorial Team



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Want to contribute to Pulse?

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